

Session 1

Storytelling & Product Pitching



Turn your project into a story people remember.

Part	Topic	Time
01	Why stories beat feature lists	4 min
02	The pitch structure: Problem → Solution → Technology → Impact	8 min
03	The Hero's Journey: your user is the hero	8 min
04	Workshop: a 5-minute pitch script	10 min

Builds on your Lean Canvas and 3-minute problem pitch from M4 Session 2.

Six words you will hear today.

Word	Plain meaning
Pitch	A short talk that convinces listeners your problem matters and your solution is worth backing.
Hook	The first sentence or two, made to grab attention.
Impact	What changes for people because your product exists.
Hero's Journey	A story pattern: a hero meets a problem, gets help, overcomes it and is changed.
Guide	The wise helper who gives the hero a plan — in a pitch, your product.
Call to action	The last line: what you want listeners to do next.

Facts tell; stories sell.

“2 hours 10 minutes, shot in 4K” — nobody cares. “A girl crosses the whole city to find her lost dog” — now you want to watch.

Listeners remember a person with a problem long after they forget your sensor’s name. Features still matter — inside the story.

Problem → Solution → Technology → Impact.

Part	Question	Smart Garden example
Problem	Who is struggling, and with what?	“Students who travel for competitions come back to dead plants.”
Solution	What does it do, in one sentence?	“A pot that waters itself, only when the soil is actually dry.”
Technology	How does it work — simply?	“A probe measures how wet the soil is; the board waters below 30 % and stops above 60 %.”
Impact	What changes, and how do you know?	“In our test, [the plant stayed healthy for 7 days away]. [3] of [5] students asked for one.”

Impact needs evidence you collected.

“Millions will love it” proves nothing. “[3] of [5] people we interviewed lose a plant every term” does.

Replace every [] with your own real numbers from interviews and tests — never invent one.

Your user is the hero. Your product is the guide.

Like an adventure film: an ordinary person, a problem, a wise guide with a plan, a hard moment, a victory, a changed life.

Not you, not your product — the user. Then listeners care about what helped them.

Six beats, mapped onto the pitch.

Beat	In your pitch (Smart Garden)	Part
1. Ordinary world	Mei, a student, loves her desk plants and competes in robotics.	Problem
2. The problem	Every competition weekend, her plants dry out. Three died this term.	Problem
3. Meets the guide	The Smart Garden: it checks the soil and waters only when needed.	Solution
4. The plan	A soil probe, two thresholds and a pump — no flooding, no forgetting.	Technology
5. The victory	Mei spends a week at the finals; the plant is fine when she returns.	Impact
6. A changed world	She travels without worrying — and her teammates want one too.	Impact

Write your six beats. 3 minutes.

One sentence per beat, for your own project.

Who is your hero? If the answer is “me” or “my product”, start again.

A 5-minute pitch script.

Part	Time	What to say
Hook	30 s	Your hero in their ordinary world, or a surprising moment from your interviews.
Problem	60 s	Beat 2: the problem, who has it, and what your interviews found.
Solution	60 s	Beat 3: your product in one sentence. Show it or a photo.
Technology	75 s	Beat 4: what it senses, decides and does — in plain words. Use your M4 flowchart.
Impact	45 s	Beats 5 and 6: what changed in your tests, with real numbers.
Close	30 s	A call to action: “Try it at our stand”, “We’re looking for five testers”.

Write it, time it, test it.

Step	Do this
1	Pick your hero and write the six beats.
2	Write the script in the six parts, in full sentences — the way you'll say it.
3	Read it aloud with a stopwatch. Mark where each part ends.
4	Too long? Cut technical detail and extra features — never the problem or the hero.
5	Swap with a partner: they underline one sentence they'll remember, and circle one they didn't understand.

Let the AI find where the product steals the spotlight.

IN THE WORKSPACE AI CHAT

Point out any sentence where the product, not the user, is the hero, and suggest a rewrite. Don't add any facts or numbers I haven't given you.

Check every suggestion — the AI must not invent results for your Impact part.

Checkpoint 1

Put the four pitch parts in order.

READ THE CODE

Technology · Impact ·
Problem · Solution

ANSWER

P → **S** → **T** → **I**

WHY

Problem, Solution, Technology, Impact: listeners must care about the problem before the technology means anything.

Checkpoint 2

In the Hero's Journey version of your pitch, who is the hero?

READ THE CODE

You · Your product ·
Your user · The judges

ANSWER

Your user

WHY

Your product is the guide that helps them.

Checkpoint 3

A pitch opens: “Our product uses an ESP32 board, a soil probe and a pump.” What’s wrong?

READ THE CODE

```
"Our product uses an ESP32  
board, a soil probe and  
a water pump."
```

ANSWER

Tech first

WHY

Open with a hook — the hero and their problem — and bring the parts in during the Technology section.

An Impact slide says “Millions of people will love this.” What’s wrong?

READ THE CODE

```
"Millions of people  
will love this."
```

ANSWER

A wish

WHY

Not evidence. Use what you measured: “[3] of [5] students we interviewed...” — with your real numbers.

Your script runs 7 minutes. What do you cut first?

READ THE CODE

```
Hook · Problem · Solution ·  
Technology detail · Impact ·  
Close
```

ANSWER

Detail

WHY

Technical detail and extra features. Keep the hero, the problem and the evidence.

Three things to take away.

1

Stories beat feature lists: people remember a person with a problem.

2

Problem → Solution → Technology → Impact, with impact backed by real numbers you collected.

3

Your user is the hero and your product is the guide — write the 5-minute script that way, and cut detail, not the story.

Next — Session 2: Presentation techniques. Slides with diagrams and demos, body language and voice, nerves, and live demos with a backup plan.